

Contributions

Three descriptive additions: an anticipatory window, a formal contrast, and a bridge between literatures.

01 THE ANTICIPATORY WINDOW

Before the deal is public

Reads residual CEO Q&A uncertainty in the anticipatory window before an acquisition becomes public.

Positions uncertainty language where prior work had read managed tone, strategy vocabulary, or prices.

02 A FORMAL CONTRAST

Cash against stock

Documents that the language pattern concentrates in cash acquisitions rather than stock.

Tests the contrast directly in a pooled model, rather than comparing separate significance results.

03 A LITERATURE BRIDGE

Private to public

Reads unscripted Q&A as tracking a deal's passage from private to public.

Connects research on withholding private information with evidence that markets anticipate corporate transactions.

CONTRIBUTION TYPE

Descriptive

The thesis **characterizes a regularity**; it does not identify a causal channel.